BENCHMARK® INTERNATIONAL

MIDDLE MARKET

QUARTERLY INDUSTRY REPORT | Q4 2026

# INDUSTRIAL

*Order books are full, the deal market has become more selective and buyers are paying the most for power, data center, aerospace and service revenue.*

- Manufacturing & Industrial Technology
- Industrial Distribution & Services
- Building Products & Construction Services
- Energy, Power & Environmental Services
- Transportation & Logistics

WHAT'S INCLUDED


01 **Insights**
Market insights, the power demand buildout and a featured engagement

02 **Industry Activity**
Recent transactions, public company valuation and operating metrics, and economic trends

03 **Connect With Us**
The Middle Market industrial team


October 2026 | Jared Hardin, Managing Director

# 01 Insights

American manufacturing has expanded for nine consecutive months, and acquirers in every industrial sector are buying capacity that already exists because skilled labor is scarce and new equipment takes a long time to arrive. Borrowing costs rose in September, and buyers have become more selective about what they pay for.

## KEY INSIGHTS

**01 Power and data center work earns the premium**
Quanta Services ended June with $53.4 billion of backlog, up from $35.8 billion. A buyer will ask how much of yours is tied to funded power and data center work.

**02 The likely buyer is an operating platform**
Add-ons made up about three-quarters of buyouts in the second quarter, and Pye-Barker Fire & Safety completed 22 acquisitions in the first half. Expect a sponsor that already knows the trade.

**03 Report service revenue on its own line**
APi Group is working toward 60% of revenue from inspection and service. Buyers pay more for service, repair and aftermarket revenue when it is reported apart from projects, with its renewal history.

**04 Financing costs more and buyers are choosier**
The Federal Reserve raised its target range to 3.75% to 4.00% on September 16. GF Data's average multiple eased to 7.0 times trailing adjusted EBITDA, from 7.3 times.





# Market Insights: Q4 2026

Demand is broad, buyers are organized around platforms and financing became more expensive in September.



WHAT IT MEANS FOR OWNERS

*Strategic acquirers and private equity platforms are still buying machining, distribution, contracting, environmental and logistics capacity that already exists.*

They are paying the most for companies tied to power, data centers, aerospace and service work that codes and regulations require.

### Domestic manufacturing demand is broad

The ISM Manufacturing PMI was 54.5 in September, its ninth consecutive month of expansion, and orders for manufacturing technology reached $4.03 billion in the first seven months of the year, 37.1% ahead of 2025 (ISM; AMT data reported by MDM). Capacity utilization of 75.7% leaves most plants room to take on more work (Federal Reserve G.17).

**54.5**

ISM Manufacturing PMI, September

### Private equity is buying through platforms it already owns

Add-on acquisitions made up about three-quarters of all buyouts in the second quarter (PitchBook), and Pye-Barker Fire & Safety completed 22 acquisitions in the first half of the year alone (Pye-Barker). The sponsor at the table for a founder-owned industrial company is usually an operating platform that already knows its trade.

**13,509**

US companies held by private equity

### Power and data center work is the strongest source of demand

Quanta Services ended June with a backlog of $53.4 billion against $35.8 billion a year earlier ( Quanta Services). Public infrastructure funding is less certain, because the surface transportation authorization expired on September 30 and highway programs are running under a continuing resolution through December 11 (AASHTO Journal).

**$53.4B**

Quanta Services total backlog June 2026

### Recurring service revenue is valued above project revenue

APi Group is working toward 60% of revenue from inspection and service, and Transcat's service revenue grew 27% (APi Group; Transcat). Buyers pay more for service, repair, inspection and aftermarket parts revenue when an owner reports it separately from project and product sales, with the renewal history behind it.

**60%**

APi Group target for inspection and service revenue

### Financing costs more and buyers are more selective

Global M&A value fell 41% from the second quarter to $993 billion in the third, and the Federal Reserve raised its target range to 3.75% to 4.00% on September 16 (LSEG data reported by Reuters; Federal Reserve). GF Data's average multiple eased to 7.0 times trailing adjusted EBITDA from 7.3 times, and debt on platform acquisitions fell to 2.9 times from 3.4 times (GF Data via ACG).

**7.0x**

Average middle-market multiple of EBITDA, Q2

Figures are as reported by the linked sources. Middle-market multiple and debt figures are GF Data sponsor-reported averages for the first and second quarters of 2026.

# Power Demand: The Buildout Reaches Every Industrial Sector

Electricity demand is growing about 2% a year, the equipment to meet it is sold out years ahead and acquirers are buying existing capacity.

The Energy Information Administration expects US electricity sales to grow about 2% in 2026 and again in 2027, driven by data center development and commercial and industrial activity (EIA). NERC raised its 10-year forecast of summer peak demand growth to 224 gigawatts from 132 (POWER Magazine), and Meta alone expects capital expenditures of $130 billion to $145 billion in 2026 ( Meta).

The equipment needed to meet that demand is committed years ahead. GE Vernova's gas turbine backlog and slot reservations rose to 116 gigawatts from 100 during the second quarter (GE Vernova), and lead times for generator step-up transformers reached 160 weeks in the first quarter (Reuters, citing Wood Mackenzie). Generac's commercial and industrial sales grew 29% and its data center backlog reached about $1.6 billion (Generac).

### *AI Bottleneck Is Power, Not Chips*

*"So, it's interesting as they continue to announce all the data centers and data center sites. I've sort of always had a strong view that energy would be the constraint." Greg Abel, CEO, Berkshire Hathaway (CNBC)*

*"Well, I don't think it's going to come down to chips or the models that people create or the apps that we develop. I think the consistent theme you hear here is can we get the power generation to power these massive data centers." Toby Rice, CEO, EQT (EQT Corporation)*

*"quite frankly, the biggest issue we are now having is not a compute glut, but it's a power and it's sort of the ability to get the builds done fast enough close to power. So, if you can't do that, you may actually have a bunch of chips sitting in inventory that I can't plug in." Satya Nadella, CEO, Microsoft ( Bg2 Pod)*

## HOW THE DEMAND REACHES EACH SECTOR

### MANUFACTURING & INDUSTRIAL TECHNOLOGY

nVent agreed to buy Maverick Power, a Texas maker of switchgear and modular power for data centers, for $1.75 billion plus up to $550 million, and put the upfront payment at 11.5 times anticipated 2026 adjusted EBITDA (nVent).

### INDUSTRIAL DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

EMCOR's US Industrial Services segment grew 25.9% in the second quarter (EMCOR), and contractors with power, utility and data center customers have kept growing in a year when refiners deferred turnaround work to 2027.

### BUILDING PRODUCTS & CONSTRUCTION SERVICES

Contractors doing data center work reported 9.9 months of backlog against 8.3 months for those that are not (ABC). Limbach lowered its guidance after its gross margin fell to 21.5% from 28.0%, citing competition for skilled labor and materials in data center markets (Limbach).

### ENERGY, POWER & ENVIRONMENTAL SERVICES

Mission Critical Group bought a Texas switchgear manufacturer and a transformer supplier within four months of each other (Dallas Innovates; Distribution Strategy Group), and electrical testing and commissioning is the most contested category in the power subsector.

### TRANSPORTATION & LOGISTICS

Spending on data center construction was more than 73% higher in August than a year earlier (ABC analysis reported by MDM), and JK Technology Services bought a Virginia rigging company that works in data centers (Vertikal).



### THE BUILDOUT IN FOUR FIGURES

**224 GW**

NERC 10-year forecast of summer peak demand growth, raised from 132

**116 GW**

GE Vernova gas turbine backlog and slot reservations

**160 weeks**

Lead time for generator step-up transformers

**9.9 months**

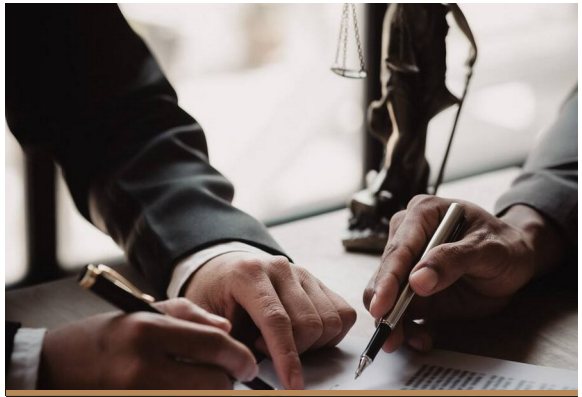
Backlog at contractors doing data center work

*A buyer will ask how much of the backlog is tied to funded power and data center work, and whether the company has the technicians to perform it at the margins it has earned so far.*

Transaction values and multiples are as stated by the acquirer in the linked announcement. Backlog figures are from company second-quarter reports and the ABC member survey for August 2026.

# Featured Engagement: The Carmi Companies

A Laredo logistics and customs brokerage group and a Mexico manufacturing services company have combined to form an end-to-end cross-border platform.



BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL ADVISED

THE CARMI COMPANIES

ON ITS TRANSACTION WITH

THE NEARSHORE COMPANY

Transportation & Logistics
Cross-border freight, customs brokerage and warehousing

READ THE ANNOUNCEMENT

THE CLIENT

## The Carmi Companies

Founded in 1983 in Laredo, Texas, The Carmi Companies is a single-source logistics group that coordinates land, air and ocean freight and provides customs brokerage, warehousing and transloading.

THE COUNTERPARTY

## The Nearshore Company

Founded in 1992 in Brownsville, Texas, The Nearshore Company offers manufacturing facilities in Mexico together with employer-of-record services.

THE RATIONALE

## An end-to-end cross-border platform

The combination pairs The Nearshore Company's Mexico manufacturing facilities and employer-of-record services with Carmi's logistics to form an end-to-end cross-border platform.

THE MARKET

## Buyers are paying for border capability

Trade with Mexico reached a monthly record of $94.8 billion in July, 27.5% above a year earlier, and $35.9 billion of it moved through Port Laredo (Census data reported by FreightWaves). Logistics platforms have responded by buying brokers at the border, and Redwood Logistics and Imperative Logistics Group each acquired a founder-owned customs broker in Laredo this year (FreightWaves on EELCO; FreightWaves on Jose D. Gonzalez, CHB).

> *"The simplest way to describe today's market is that buyers are acquiring capabilities rather than capacity."*
>
> Gaurang Shastri, Managing Director, Lincoln International, speaking to Transport Topics (Lincoln International)

BENCHMARK IN THIS SECTOR

**3**
transactions closed in the past 24 months

**14**
engagements in progress

TALK WITH THE TEAM



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MANAGING DIRECTOR
HEAD OF MIDDLE MARKET

VIEW MORE TRANSACTIONS

Company descriptions are from the announcement on benchmarkintl.com. Benchmark International counts are for the 24 months to September 30, 2026 and for engagements in progress as of October 1, 2026.

# 02

# Industry Activity

Acquirers announced transactions in every industrial sector during 2026, with sellers that ranged from founder-owned machine shops and customs brokers to companies bought by public acquirers for several billion dollars. Listed industrial companies trade at a median of 16.2 times EBITDA, and the indicators behind demand and financing are pointing in different directions.

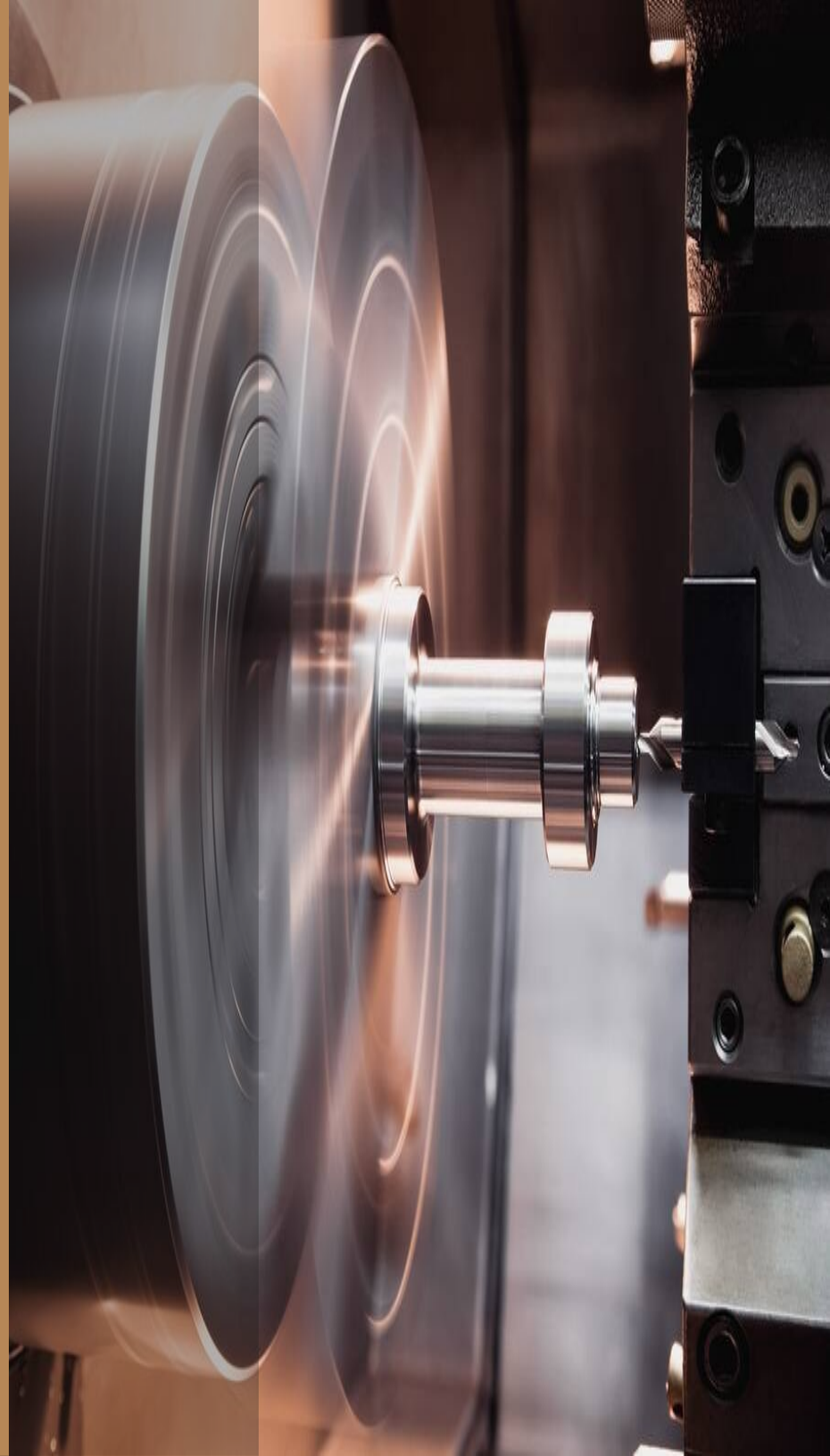

07 Select recent industrial transactions

09 Benchmark International's industrial transactions

10 Public company performance and trends

13 Economic trends



# Select Recent Industrial Transactions

Public acquirers disclosed prices of about 6 to 10 times EBITDA, and sponsor-owned platforms bought family-owned companies on undisclosed terms.

| ANNOUNCED | TARGET AND ACQUIRER | BUSINESS AND TERMS | WHAT IT SHOWS |
|---|---|---|---|
| SEPTEMBER 2026<br>Manufacturing & Industrial Tech | **CAT PUMPS**<br>*acquired by*<br>**FRANKLIN ELECTRIC** | Franklin Electric acquired Cat Pumps, a Minneapolis maker of high-pressure pumps, for $350 million in cash plus up to $50 million in stock (Franklin Electric). | The upfront payment equals about 7.8 times 2025 adjusted EBITDA, by our calculation, for a business with a margin above 35%. |
| JULY 2026<br>Manufacturing & Industrial Tech | **ADVANCE MFG. CO.**<br>*acquired by*<br>**PRECINMAC**<br>Centerbridge Partners | Precinmac acquired Advance Mfg. Co. of Westfield, Massachusetts, family-owned since 1961, which supplies machined components, fabrications and Nadcap coating for defense and aerospace customers (Precinmac). Terms were not disclosed. | Sponsor-owned platforms are assembling certified aerospace and defense machining capacity, and Precinmac had acquired Precision Aerospace Holdings of Dallas in April. |
| JULY 2026<br>Distribution & Services | **FLOWORKS**<br>*acquired by*<br>**FERGUSON** | Ferguson agreed to buy FloWorks, a flow control distributor with about $1 billion of revenue, from Wynnchurch Capital for $1.6 billion and completed the purchase in August (MDM). | Ferguson described the price as about 10 times trailing adjusted EBITDA after including roughly $45 million of expected synergies (MDM). |
| JULY 2026<br>Distribution & Services | **METROPLEX WELDING SUPPLY**<br>*acquired by*<br>**MERITUS GAS PARTNERS**<br>AEA Investors | Meritus Gas Partners acquired Metroplex Welding Supply of Dallas, a family-owned distributor of industrial gases and welding supplies founded in 1975 with five locations (MDM). Terms were not disclosed. | Meritus has announced at least five acquisitions in 2026, four of them since July, and nearly every product line now has a specialist acquirer of this kind. |
| SEPTEMBER 2026<br>Building Products & Construction | **1901 INC.**<br>*acquired by*<br>**LIMBACH HOLDINGS** | Limbach acquired 1901 Inc., a mechanical, electrical and plumbing contractor in Madison, Wisconsin, that it expects to contribute about $140 million of revenue, for $63 million plus an earn-out of up to $6 million (Pulse 2.0). | The upfront payment is about 5.7 times expected 2027 adjusted EBITDA, by our calculation, just below the 6 to 9 times at which project-based contractors have traded. |



Transaction values and multiples are as reported by the linked source or calculated from the figures it gives. Company names are the property of their owners and are shown for identification. Transactions advised by Benchmark International appear on page 9.

# Select Recent Industrial Transactions (Continued)

Buyers in power, environmental services and logistics paid for technicians, permits, equipment supply and border capability they did not already have.

| ANNOUNCED | TARGET AND ACQUIRER | BUSINESS AND TERMS | WHAT IT SHOWS |
|---|---|---|---|
| AUGUST 2026<br>Building Products & Construction | **CLARK RIGGING & RENTAL**<br>*acquired by*<br>**BAY CRANE** | Bay Crane acquired Clark Rigging & Rental, a crane rental, rigging and heavy-haul company in upstate New York that had been family-owned since 1954 (RER). Terms were not disclosed. | Crane, rigging and pump rental each have an active acquirer buying family-owned regional operators. |
| AUGUST 2026<br>Energy, Power & Environmental | **ENVIROSERVE**<br>*acquired by*<br>**CLEAN HARBORS** | Clean Harbors agreed to buy EnviroServe, a remediation, industrial cleaning and emergency response company with 40 locations, from One Rock Capital Partners for $470 million (Waste Advantage). | The agreement followed Clean Harbors' $305 million deal for ES&H, which it described as 8.7 times EBITDA after synergies (Clean Harbors). |
| JULY 2026<br>Energy, Power & Environmental | **CORE TRANSFORMERS**<br>*acquired by*<br>**MISSION CRITICAL GROUP**<br>Emerald Lake Capital Management | Mission Critical Group acquired CORE Transformers, a founder-led supplier of new, made-to-order and remanufactured power transformers ( Distribution Strategy Group). Terms were not disclosed. | It was the buyer's second power equipment purchase in four months, after the Texas switchgear maker TxLa Systems. |
| OCTOBER 2026<br>Transportation & Logistics | **RXO**<br>*acquired by*<br>**C.H. ROBINSON** | C.H. Robinson agreed on October 5 to acquire RXO, a truck brokerage, managed transportation and last-mile provider, at an implied value of $5.8 billion, a 29% premium to RXO's last closing price (C.H. Robinson and RXO). | About $300 million of expected annual cost savings supports the price at the top of the brokerage market. |
| MARCH 2026<br>Transportation & Logistics | **EELCO**<br>*acquired by*<br>**REDWOOD LOGISTICS**<br>AEA Investors | Redwood Logistics acquired EELCO, a Laredo, Texas, customs brokerage with a foreign-trade-zone warehouse that had been founder-owned since 1991 ( FreightWaves). Terms were not disclosed. | Logistics platforms are buying brokers at the border as trade with Mexico sets monthly records. |



Transaction values and multiples are as reported by the linked source or calculated from the figures it gives. Company names are the property of their owners and are shown for identification. Two transactions are shown for each of the five industrial sectors across pages 7 and 8.

# Benchmark International's Industrial Transactions

Building products and construction services is the most active sector, and strategic acquirers were the buyers in more than half of the sales.

TRAILING 24 MONTHS

**85**

industrial transactions closed in the five sectors

**212**

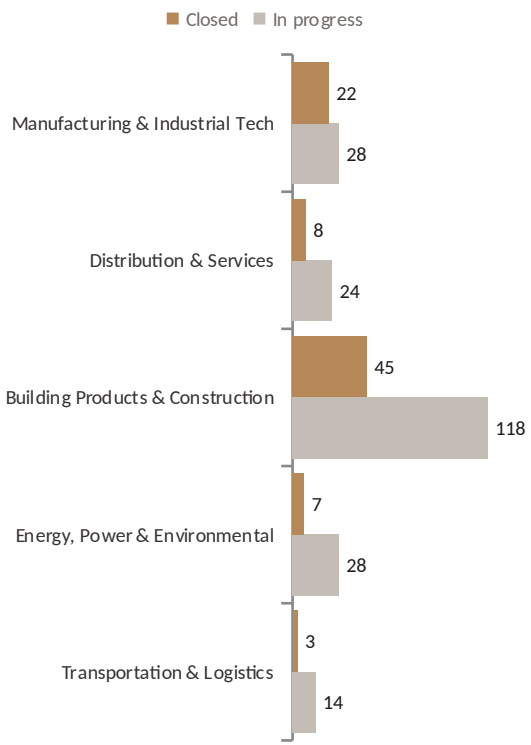
industrial engagements in progress as of October 1, 2026

**56%**

of the 71 companies with a classified buyer were bought by a strategic acquirer

Ranked the leading privately owned sell-side M&A advisor in the world in PitchBook's Q2 2026 Global League Tables (Benchmark International).

## BY SECTOR




## WHO BOUGHT

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Strategic acquirer | **40** | 56% |
| Sponsor-owned platform | **13** | 18% |
| Financial sponsor | **10** | 14% |
| Individual investor | **8** | 11% |

## SELECTED ANNOUNCED ENGAGEMENTS

**FPS Technologies, Inc.**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**CINTAS CORPORATION**
Fire suppression and detection systems
DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

**MaxVac Inc.**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**DXP ENTERPRISES, INC.**
Sales, repair and maintenance of industrial vacuum pumps
MANUFACTURING

**Trinity Industrial Services, LLC**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**AECON GROUP INC.**
Industrial maintenance, capital projects and turnarounds
DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

**Invocon, Inc.**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**CEMTREX, INC.**
Instrumentation and wireless sensing for aerospace platforms
MANUFACTURING

**Climate Engineering, Inc.**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**HARRIS COMPANY**
Commercial HVAC and building automation
BUILDING & CONSTRUCTION

**Briggs Engineering & Testing**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**PHENNA GROUP**
Geotechnical and materials testing and special inspection
BUILDING & CONSTRUCTION

**Capitol Plastics Recycling Inc.**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**TRIUMVIRATE ENVIRONMENTAL**
Industrial plastics recycling
ENERGY & ENVIRONMENTAL

**WESCO Chemicals, Inc.**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**APEX WATER AND PROCESS INC.**
Water treatment chemical production and service
ENERGY & ENVIRONMENTAL

**DW Industries**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**TIPCO TECHNOLOGIES**
Hose and hose assemblies for industrial customers
DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

**A.T. Parker, Inc. (Solar Electronics)**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**ASSESSIMUS GROUP GMBH**
Test equipment for electromagnetic interference
MANUFACTURING

**Clark Crane, LLC**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**CAPITAL EXTENSION CRANE & LIFT**
Crane rental and rigging
BUILDING & CONSTRUCTION

**Christian Network International**
HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY
**SYMBIA LOGISTICS**
Fulfillment and distribution
TRANSPORTATION

BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL

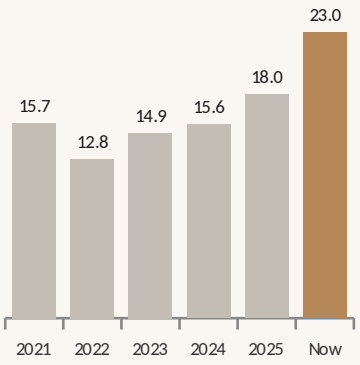
Each tile links to the announcement on benchmarkintl.com. Counts are from Benchmark International's transaction records for the 24 months to September 30, 2026; engagements in progress are shown in aggregate. Fifty-nine of the 85 closed transactions have been announced publicly.

# Public Company Performance and Trends: Valuation History

Manufacturing, distribution and transportation companies trade above every year-end multiple of the past five years.

### Manufacturing & Industrial Tech

**23.0x** median today

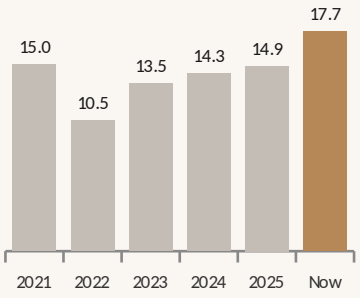



| | |
|---|---|
| Five-year high | **18.0x** |
| Five-year low | **12.8x** |
| Five-year median | **15.6x** |
| Today against the median | **+7.3x** |

**7 companies:** Parker Hannifin, Rockwell Automation, ITT, Flowserve, Franklin Electric, Sanmina, Howmet Aerospace

### Distribution & Services

**17.7x** median today

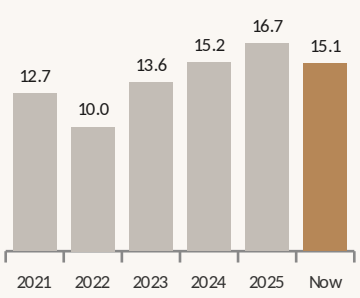



| | |
|---|---|
| Five-year high | **15.0x** |
| Five-year low | **10.5x** |
| Five-year median | **14.3x** |
| Today against the median | **+3.4x** |

**8 companies:** Fastenal, W.W. Grainger, Applied Industrial Technologies, MSC Industrial Direct, DXP Enterprises, Distribution Solutions, API, WESCO

### Building Products & Construction

**15.1x** median today

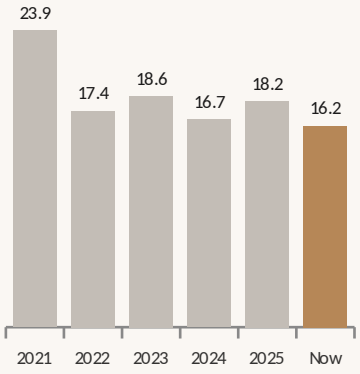



| | |
|---|---|
| Five-year high | **16.6x** |
| Five-year low | **9.9x** |
| Five-year median | **13.6x** |
| Today against the median | **+1.5x** |

**8 companies:** Comfort Systems USA, EMCOR, IES, Limbach, Granite Construction, Construction Partners, Builders FirstSource, Watsco

### Energy, Power & Environmental

**16.2x** median today

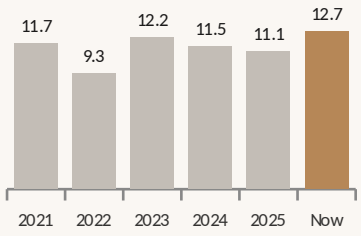



| | |
|---|---|
| Five-year high | **23.9x** |
| Five-year low | **16.7x** |
| Five-year median | **18.2x** |
| Today against the median | **−2.0x** |

**8 companies:** Generac, Quanta Services, Clean Harbors, Republic Services, Waste Connections, Casella Waste Systems, Xylem, Willdan

### Transportation & Logistics

**12.7x** median today




| | |
|---|---|
| Five-year high | **12.2x** |
| Five-year low | **9.3x** |
| Five-year median | **11.4x** |
| Today against the median | **+1.3x** |

**7 companies:** J.B. Hunt, Knight-Swift, Werner Enterprises, C.H. Robinson, Kirby, Landstar System, Schneider National

## PRIVATE-MARKET REFERENCE POINTS

*Listed multiples describe companies many times larger than a founder-owned business and show relative standing among the sectors.*

**7.0x**

Average for completed middle-market transactions in all industries in the second quarter of 2026 ( GF Data via ACG)

**5.8x**

Median for transactions of $5 million to $50 million in all industries in the second quarter of 2026 ( IBBA and M&A Source)

**5.0x to 8.0x**

Survey medians for manufacturing, wholesale and construction companies with $1 million to $25 million of EBITDA (Pepperdine)

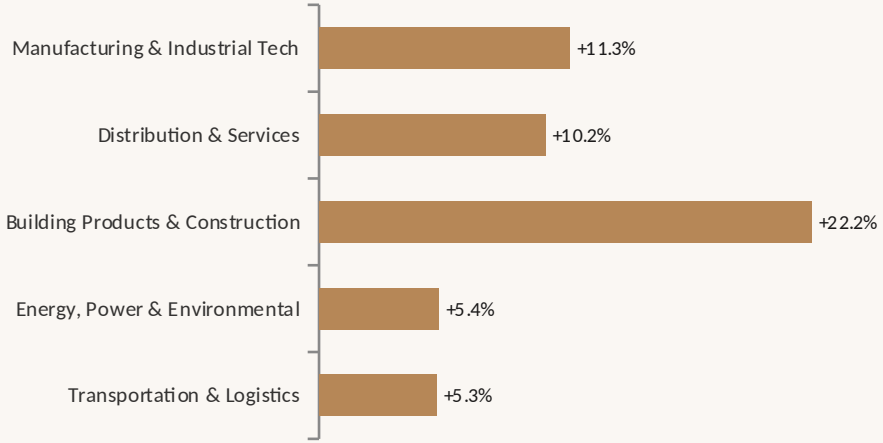
Median enterprise value to trailing EBITDA for 38 listed companies at each company's fiscal year-end from 2021 to 2025 and today; the five-year high, low and median under each chart use the year-end values. Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 5 to 7, 2026, with share prices from September 28 to October 7, 2026. Multiples use reported EBITDA.

# Public Company Performance and Trends: Operating Metrics

Building products and construction companies are growing revenue about 22% a year, and manufacturers earn the highest margins.

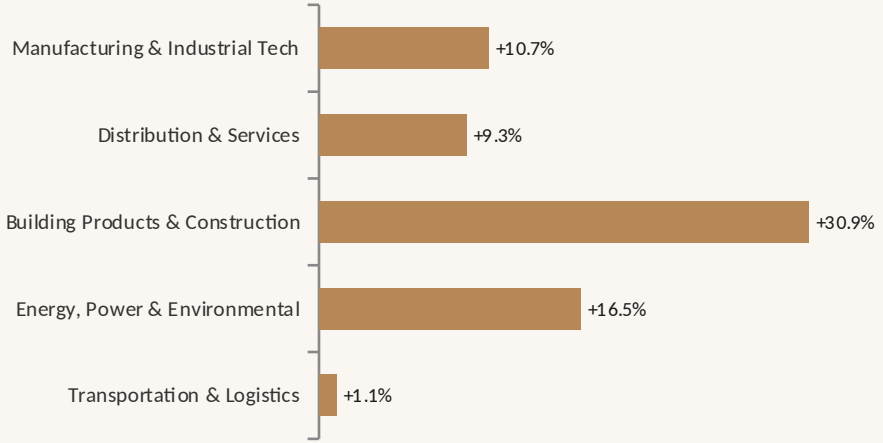
### Median revenue growth

Trailing twelve months against the prior twelve, including acquisitions



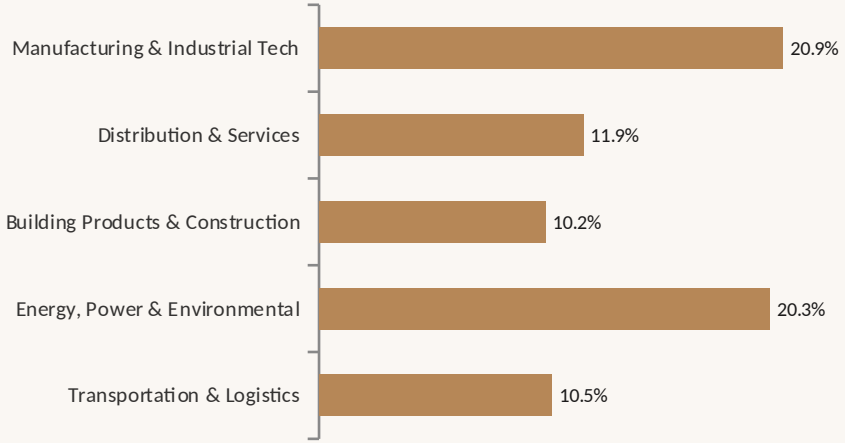

### Median EBITDA growth

Latest fiscal year against the prior fiscal year, on reported EBITDA



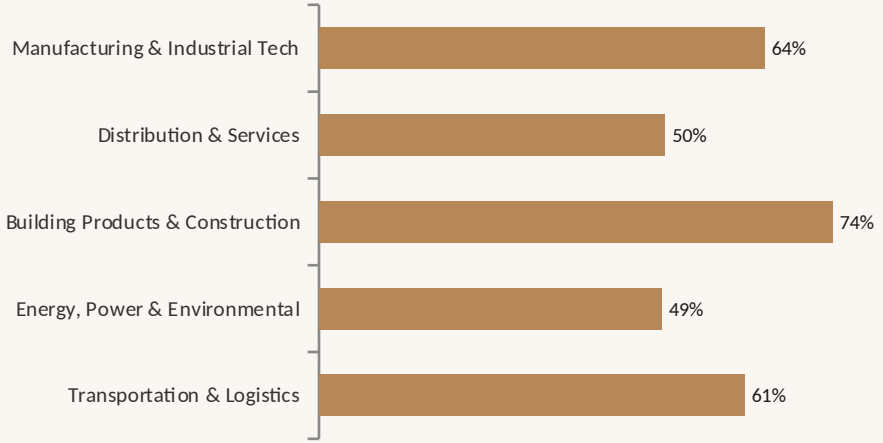

### Median EBITDA margin

Trailing twelve months, on reported EBITDA




### Median free cash flow conversion

Trailing free cash flow as a share of trailing EBITDA



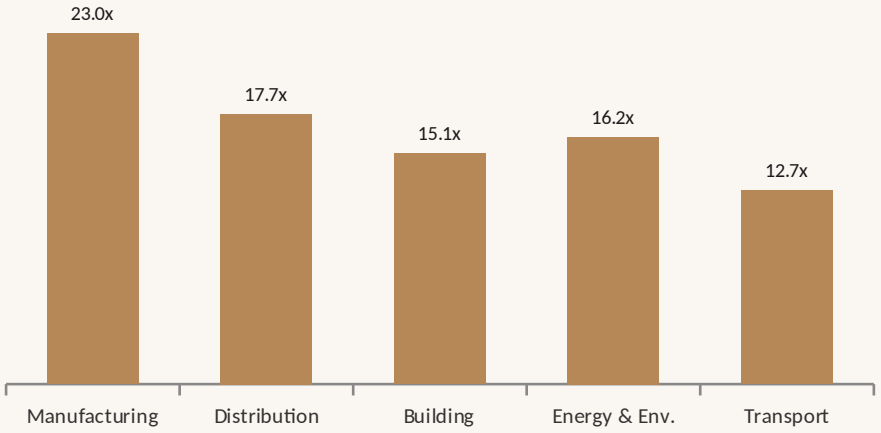

Medians of the 38 listed companies shown on page 10, grouped by sector. Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 5 to 7, 2026. Trailing periods end between April and July 2026. EBITDA is as reported and is lower than the adjusted EBITDA that companies present. Forward estimates are not included.

# Public Company Performance and Trends: Valuation Metrics

Transportation shares rose a median 43% in a year and still trade at the lowest multiple of EBITDA of the five sectors.

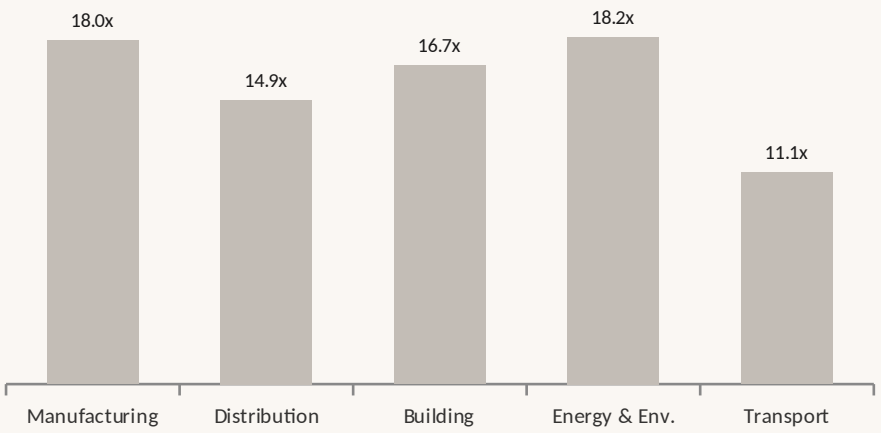
### Median enterprise value to trailing EBITDA

Today, on share prices from September 28 to October 7, 2026



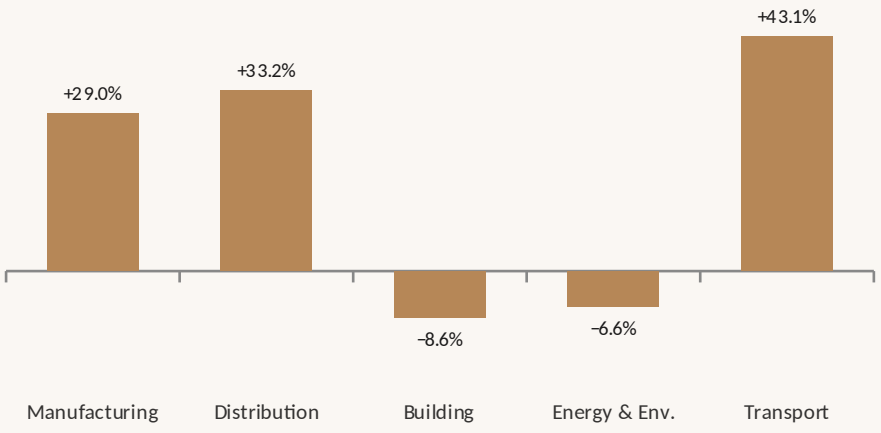

### Median enterprise value to EBITDA at fiscal year-end 2025

At each company's 2025 fiscal year-end, for comparison with today



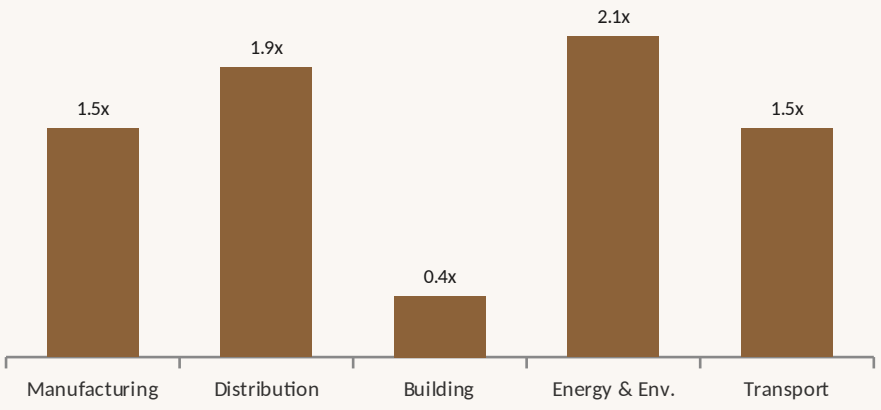

### Median change in share price over 52 weeks

Shares rose at 7 of 7 manufacturing, 8 of 8 distribution, 4 of 8 building, 3 of 8 energy and 7 of 7 transport companies




### Median net debt to trailing EBITDA

Total debt less cash, divided by trailing reported EBITDA




Medians of the 38 listed companies shown on page 10, grouped by sector. Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 5 to 7, 2026. Year-end 2025 multiples stand in for the forward multiples that a licensed data service would provide. Three of the eight building products and construction companies hold more cash than debt.

# Economic Trends

Capital goods orders are 14% above a year ago, diesel is up 68% and the 10-year Treasury yield averaged 4.99% in September.

### Core capital goods orders

Nondefense capital goods excluding aircraft, monthly, US Census Bureau

**$87.6B**
Aug 2026

**+14.1%**
over one year



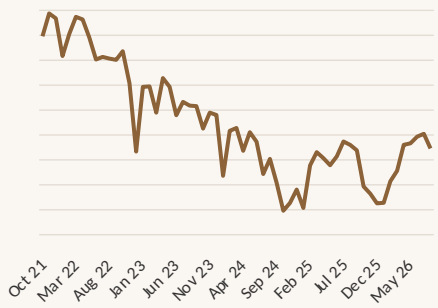

Source: FRED, series NEWORDER

### Manufacturing capacity utilization

Share of manufacturing capacity in use, Federal Reserve

**75.7%**
Aug 2026

**−0.1 pts**
over one year



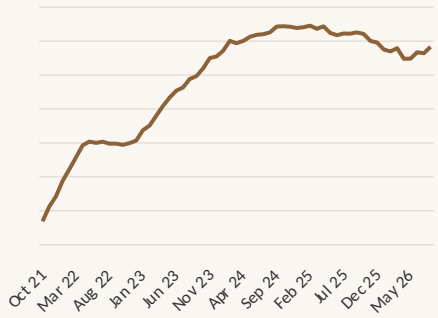

Source: FRED, series MCUMFN

### Total construction spending

Seasonally adjusted annual rate, US Census Bureau

**$2.20T**
Aug 2026

**−1.7%**
over one year



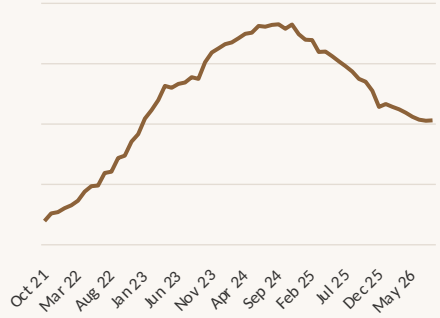

Source: FRED, series TTLCONS

### Manufacturing construction

Spending at a seasonally adjusted annual rate, US Census Bureau

**$170.7B**
Aug 2026

**−19.2%**
over one year



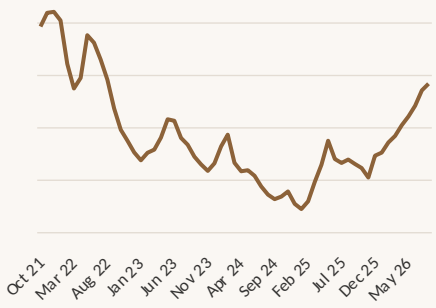

Source: FRED, series TLMFGCONS

### Steel mill product prices

Producer price index, 1982 = 100, Bureau of Labor Statistics

**381.2**
Aug 2026

**+23.4%**
over one year



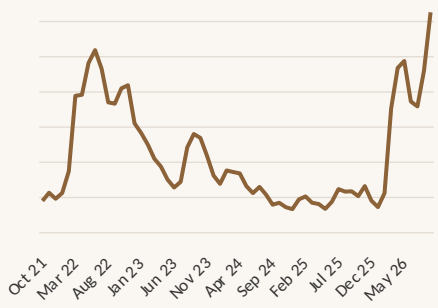

Source: FRED, series WPU1017

### Diesel price

US average retail price per gallon, month end, EIA

**$6.29**
Sep 2026

**+67.8%**
over one year



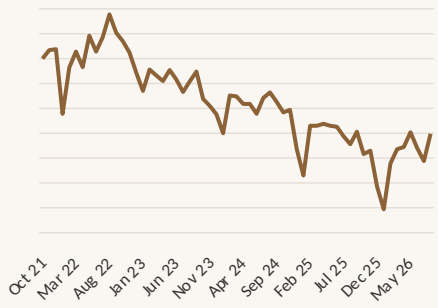

Source: FRED, series GASDESM

### Cass Freight Index: shipments

January 1990 = 1.00, Cass Information Systems

**1.038**
Aug 2026

**+2.1%**
over one year



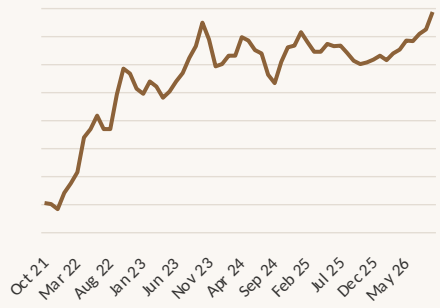

Source: FRED, series FRGSHPUSM649NCIS

### 10-year Treasury yield

Monthly average of daily yields, Federal Reserve

**4.99%**
Sep 2026

**+0.87 pts**
over one year




Source: FRED, series GS10

Each series runs monthly from October 2021 to its latest reading, which is August 2026 for all series except diesel and the Treasury yield (September 2026). Recent months are preliminary and subject to revision.

# 03

# Connect With Us

Benchmark International's Middle Market team represents owners of privately held companies with $50 million to $500 million of total enterprise value on strategic sales, mergers, and qualifying change-of-control transactions. The first step is a confidential conversation about your goals, your company and your options, with no pressure and no commitment.


15 Connect with our team

16 Our team

17 Important disclosures

18 Sources


BENCHMARK® INTERNATIONAL MIDDLE MARKET



# Connect With Our Team

A first conversation is confidential and carries no obligation.

CONFIDENTIAL. NO PRESSURE. NO COMMITMENTS.

## It all starts with a conversation.

We welcome calls from owners considering a strategic sale, merger or change-of-control transaction in any of our five industries, and from the accountants, attorneys and wealth advisors who work with them. Every engagement is led by the Middle Market team and backed by Benchmark International's global network of strategic acquirers, private equity groups, family offices and independent sponsors.



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### Alex Zykov

TRANSACTION DIRECTOR



### Shannon Hess

CLIENT ENGAGEMENT DIRECTOR

**01 Share a few details**

Tell us about your company and what you are considering. Everything you share is held in strict confidence.

**02 Talk with a Managing Director**

A senior member of the team will set up a private conversation at a time that suits you.

**03 See your options clearly**

Understand the paths available, from a strategic sale to a merger or change-of-control transaction, and what each could mean for you.

SCHEDULE A CONVERSATION

READ THE REPORT ONLINE

BENCHMARK® INTERNATIONAL

MIDDLE MARKET

**#1**
Privately owned sell-side M&A advisor worldwide

**15**
Global offices across the Americas, Europe and Africa

**$50M to $500M**
Total enterprise value range the team serves

INDUSTRIAL COVERAGE

- Manufacturing & Industrial Technology
- Industrial Distribution & Services
- Building Products & Construction Services
- Energy, Power & Environmental Services
- Transportation & Logistics

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Ranking based on PitchBook's Q2 2026 Global League Tables, as published at benchmarkintl.com. Team as listed on the Middle Market site in October 2026.

# Our Team

The Middle Market team leads each engagement from the first conversation through signing and closing.

## Middle Market

Benchmark International's Middle Market team represents owners of privately held companies with $50 million to $500 million of total enterprise value on strategic sales, mergers, and qualifying change-of-control transactions.

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**Sunny Garten**
Senior Deal Associate



**Michael Wynn**
Senior Deal Associate



**Jason Lisiak**
Research Associate



**Alexandra Barr**
Transaction Support Associate



**Josiah Warren**
Transaction Support Associate



**Luke Ernst**
Deal Analyst

### INDUSTRIAL COVERAGE

- Manufacturing & Industrial Technology
- Industrial Distribution & Services
- Building Products & Construction Services
- Energy, Power & Environmental Services
- Transportation & Logistics

# Important Disclosures

These disclosures apply to this brief and to the Middle Market industry reports.

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# Sources

Every figure in this brief links to the page it came from, and the same links are collected here by section.

### INSIGHTS (PAGES 3 TO 5)

ISM prnewswire.com
AMT data reported by MDM mdm.com
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PitchBook pitchbook.brightspotcdn.com
Pye-Barker pyebarkerfs.com
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APi Group businesswire.com
Transcat transcat.com
LSEG data reported by Reuters globalbankingandfinance.com
Federal Reserve federalreserve.gov
GF Data via ACG acg.org
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Meta prnewswire.com
GE Vernova sec.gov
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EMCOR sec.gov
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FreightWaves on Jose D. Gonzalez, CHB freightwaves.com
Lincoln International lincolninternational.com
Bg2 Pod bg2pod.com
CNBC cnbc.com
EQT Corporation youtube.com/@EQTCorp
Quanta Services quantaservices.com/

### TRANSACTIONS (PAGES 7 AND 8)

Franklin Electric and Cat Pumps: Franklin Electric franklin-electric.com
Precinmac and Advance Mfg. Co.: Precinmac prnewswire.com
Ferguson and FloWorks: MDM mdm.com
Ferguson and FloWorks: MDM mdm.com
Meritus Gas Partners and Metroplex Welding Supply: MDM mdm.com
Limbach Holdings and 1901 Inc.: Pulse 2.0 pulse2.com
Bay Crane and Clark Rigging & Rental: RER rermag.com
Clean Harbors and EnviroServe: Waste Advantage wasteadvantagemag.com
Clean Harbors and EnviroServe: Clean Harbors sec.gov
C.H. Robinson and RXO sec.gov

### BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL (PAGES 5, 9 AND 15)

The Carmi Companies and The Nearshore Company benchmarkintl.com
FPS Technologies, Inc. and Cintas Corporation benchmarkintl.com
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Christian Network International and Symbia Logistics benchmarkintl.com
Benchmark International benchmarkintl.com
Middle Market: Industrial Q4 2026 M&A Industry Report jp-hardin.github.io

### PUBLIC COMPANIES AND ECONOMIC TRENDS (PAGES 10 TO 13)

IBBA and M&A Source ibba.org
Pepperdine digitalcommons.pepperdine.edu
StockAnalysis stockanalysis.com
FRED: Core capital goods orders (NEWORDER) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Manufacturing capacity utilization (MCUMFN) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Total construction spending (TTLCONS) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Manufacturing construction (TLMFGCONS) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Steel mill product prices (WPU1017) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Diesel price (GASDESM) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Cass Freight Index: shipments (FRGSHPUSM649NCIS) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: 10-year Treasury yield (GS10) fred.stlouisfed.org

**How the figures were gathered.** Listed-company figures are from StockAnalysis and use reported results. Economic series are from FRED. Benchmark International figures are from the firm's transaction records as of October 1, 2026. Subscription and registration sources that would add depth, including GF Data, PitchBook and S&P Capital IQ, are listed in a separate one-page companion.